STYLE GUIDE

Everything you need to know about how we structure our writing.

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ABOUT GGRECON

GGRecon was founded in December 2019 with just two members of staff. Since then, it has grown into a social, video, and editorial team, all with the same vision of becoming the biggest (and best) esports publisher in the world.

As a member of the team, you are expected to ensure consistency in tone and style across everything we do.

We are friendly, entertaining, and informative. We double-check all of our information, and don't publish anything that we're unsure of.

We have dignity, and a strong understanding of media law.

This Style Guide includes everything that you will need to ensure that your writing is the best that it possibly can be in terms of formatting, style, punctuation, and grammar.

In terms of the content itself, that's down to you and your incredible journalistic talent.

Please ensure you read (and re-read!) this document to familiarise yourself with the standard we expect.

VOICE AND TONE

GGRecon produces fresh, relevant, informative content. Here are a few notes on the voice and tone to use in your writing:

Friendly and accessible, but not overly casual

We don't use 'lol' or 'OMG'. If someone has used these terms in a Tweet, status, or interview - that's fine and an exception to the rule.

Expert, but not a know-it-all

We never put our audience down for not knowing something about esports or gaming. We aim to be informative as much as we can. However, 'in-jokes' are acceptable.

Fun, but not slapstick or childish

Self-explanatory, really. No blue jokes.

Also, no sexism, racism, homophobia, ableism, transphobia, or discrimination of any sort. Ever.

VOICE AND TONE

We are not a ‘blog’. We are a news site. You can use ‘I’ when the article is opinion-based, but make this very clear.

Also ensure you have approval from the freelancer coordinator to do an opinion piece first.

We report on serious news, as well as entertainment, and want our audience to trust us and our knowledge.

Do not write out swear words in full. In the rare case that you are using one, format it with asterisks between the first and last letters.

Ex. While on Twitch, the streamer shouted: "F**k!".

There are exceptions, for example - sh*t - where the word could be one of several swear words, so you need to differentiate by giving an extra letter.

VOICE AND TONE

When it comes to certain pieces of content, our tone needs to adapt. For example, a light article can be written in a much more relaxed way than straight-up news about a serious subject. You will need to use your common sense when deciding this. If you are ever unsure - ask your editor.

Here are some examples of tone.

Serious, formal, respectful & matter-of-fact: “We apologise, but we are experiencing a problem.” - this would be applicable to serious news (reporting an illegal act/a death etc).

Serious, casual, respectful & matter-of-fact: “We’re sorry, but we’re experiencing a problem on our end.” - this is not a tone we would generally use.

Serious, casual, respectful & enthusiastic: “Oops! We’re sorry, but we’re experiencing a problem on our end.” - this is the tone we would use most of the time.

Funny, casual, irreverent & enthusiastic: “What did you do!? You broke it! (Just kidding. We’re experiencing a problem on our end) - for very light-hearted pieces, this is acceptable.

VOICE AND TONE

Who is our demographic?

We've summarised our audience into one person. Jacob.

A 23-year-old male called Jacob from England, who has recently graduated from university and has an entry level post-graduation job. Jacob lives in a flat with his cat called Goku, however he has a partner and they are planning on moving in together.

He is more interested in FPS games, which he plays on both console & PC. His console gaming is with people he met through school & university, and PC with people he's met over the years from all over the world through his love of gaming since he was very young. Jacob's normal life outside of gaming consists of working and spending time with his girlfriend or friends, occasionally going out for drinks on the weekend, or for meals with his girlfriend throughout the week.

VOICE AND TONE

Jacob's always had a passion for esports on his favourite games and tends to find clips of streamers and news on YouTube, whereas he occasionally watches various esport events on Twitch and follows his favourite teams, players and news source through Twitter & Reddit.

He tends to have a casual browse on Facebook / Instagram in the evening, also communicating with friends via Facebook & WhatsApp.

Jacob wears lower end designer clothing, normal named brands such as Adidas & Nike and mostly enjoys eating casual cooking (oven food), but does enjoy fast food on days when he doesn't want to cook, to get those extra gaming hours in or more time with his girlfriend.

HEADINGS AND SUBHEADINGS

Capitalise every single word in the headline.

CORRECT: The Bias Against VALORANT Players Without A CS Background

INCORRECT: The Bias against VALORANT Players without a CS Background

Avoid using ampersands (&) in headings, or subheadings - use 'and' instead.

Headline examples:

CORRECT: Fortnite 'The Device' Event: Details, Leaks, And Theories

INCORRECT: Fortnite 'The Device' Event: Details, Leaks, & Theories

HEADINGS AND SUBHEADINGS

An ampersand may be used in a headline when space is tight, or when it’s part of a company name or game/book title.

Never use speechmarks in a headling - replace with single apostophes.

CORRECT: Dave 'bench' Cecconi: 'Contenders Has Such A Narrow And Uninspired Vision'

INCORRECT: Dave "bench" Cecconi: "Contenders Has Such A Narrow And Uninspired Vision"

Do not use an ellipsis (...) in a headline.

Write out numbers (up to ten). If you're short on space, put the number.

FORMATTING AND LAYOUT

Pictures

You should aim to include 1-3 images in each piece. For breaking news, this will not be necessary as the important thing is to get the content out to our audience as soon as possible.

For articles that are heavily picture-focused (ex. Leaked Skins), the amount of images expected is a lot higher.

Make sure every image is credited. This includes the featured image. Talk to your editor about how to do this properly.

QUOTES

Use said (**not says**) when quoting someone.

Ex. “The general consensus is not to do the hokey-pokey during a tournament,” said Shawn.

Always use double quotation marks with single quotation marks inside (for names of articles, other quotes, etc).

Ex. “I read the article ‘The Dog’s Computer',” said Jake.

Ex. "I spoke to Jake, and he said he'd 'read an article'," said Chris.

Periods and commas always go inside quotation marks.

Ex. “I was playing *Pokemon GO*,” Carol said, “when I was approached by a hooded man.”

QUOTES

Question marks and exclamation points go inside quotation marks only when they're part of what the speaker is saying.

Ex. Sally said: "Would you like to go for a drink?"

Ex. Sally asked if John would like to go for a drink. Can you believe he said "I would"?

Colons, semicolons, and dashes always go outside quotation marks.

Ex. The following should report to the room marked "Staff": players, commentators, front-of-house workers, and management.

If you are quoting a magazine, newspaper, or other media publisher - link out to the article you are referring to, or to their website.

Ex. Dr DisRespect told **The Mirror**:

QUOTES

One-on-one interviews - Q&A style

For an interview with a singular person, you can format the article in a Q&A style. Put the question you asked in **bold**, and then their answer underneath (in a new paragraph) without any formatting.

Ex. **How does it feel to know that your words are being read by potentially thousands of people?**

It's the whole reason that I got into journalism. I love it and I'm humbled.

QUOTES

One-on-one interviews - Woven style

For an interview with a singular person, you can weave their answers into the article itself without using the Q&A format.

All you have to do is write out in your own words what they are saying, and back it up with their quotes.

Ex. When asked about how it feels knowing her words are being read by potentially thousands of people, Mel explained how rewarding it is. She said: "It's the whole reason that I got into journalism. I love it and I'm humbled."

QUOTES

Multiple person interviews - Q&A style

For an interview with a multiple people, you can still format the article in a Q&A style. Put the question you asked in **bold**, and then their answer underneath (in a new paragraph), however you need to put their name in bold (including the colon).

Ex. **How does it feel to know that your words are being read by potentially thousands of people?**

Jack: It's the whole reason that I got into journalism. I love it and I'm humbled.

Katie: As long as it's all formatted correctly, I'm happy.

QUOTES

Multiple person interviews - Woven style

Alternatively, you can weave their words into your article, the same as the one-on-one article. This is the preferable method when there is a lot of information duplicated from the interviewees.

For this, ensure that large blocks of quotes are broken up. End the first block of quote with a full stop, and no closing speechmarks. Open the next block with speech marks, and close it off at the end.

Ex. Yiska said: "Esports journalism is such an exciting place to be right now. The fans are so incredibly passionate, and the players so talented, being able to cover this daily is a dream come true.

"Not only do I write for GGRecon, but I am also part of a great esports podcast. It's very rewarding."

QUOTES

Quote blocks

In our CMS (Content Managing System), there is the capability to add a 'quote block'.

You should only ever use this for single sentences. They should be the most interesting line of the article, and only inserted past the half-way point.

Do not write the quote with speechmarks, the CMS will add these automatically.

Do not credit the interviewee in this block, add it underneath afterwards in a new block.

Ex:
Quote block
This is the quote. Do not add speech marks.
New text block
- Mel Ramsay

TITLES

Book and eBook titles, games, magazine and newspaper names, and movie titles should be in italics.

Ex. My favourite movie is *Blade Runner,* which is based on the book *Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep?* by Philip K. Dick.

A part or section of a larger work is put in single quotation marks. (This includes a chapter of a book, the title of an article in a magazine, etc.)

Ex. The *Harry Potter* chapter, 'Parting of the Ways', was my favourite.

Ex. The *Vanity Fair* article 'How to Tell if She's an Android' provides examples.

Ex. Check out the blog post 'How to Launch a Rocket' for more information.

TITLES

Make sure game titles are in italics throughout your piece.

CORRECT: It won't come as news to many *Apex Legends* fans that the world of *Apex* exists within the *Titanfall* universe.

INCORRECT: It won't come as news to many Apex Legends fans that the world of Apex exists within the Titanfall universe.

Always use single spaces between sentences.

ABBREVIATIONS

Avoid abbreviating any words that the audience won't understand immediately. For common abbreviations, include a period. Mr and Mrs do not require a period after them.

If the person you're referring to has a nickname, include it in the middle of their first and last name in speechmarks.

The only exception to this rule is when their name is being featured in a headline (see Headings and Subheadings page for more information).

Ex. Sgt. Kyle "Gaz" Garrick is one of the three playable protagonists of *Call of Duty: Modern Warfare.*

ACRONYMS

Spell out the full name on first reference, followed by the acronym in parentheses. It's okay to use the acronym after that.

Ex. *Counter Strike: Global Offensive* (*CS:GO*) has introduced a new game mode alongside Arms Race, Flying Scoutsman, and Wingman.

To make an acronym plural, just add the letter **s** (no apostrophe).

Ex. A new Multiplayer Online Battle Arena (MOBA) has been announced. *League of Legends* (*LoL*) is still the most popular out of all of the MOBAs.

In gaming and esports, there are a lot of acronyms that are commonly used. Like name acronyms, spell out the full term for the first reference, followed by the acronym in parentheses. Any other mentions in the piece can be acronym only.

Ex. *Final Fantasy VI* is a role-playing game (RPG) that was released in 1994. It came second in the *IGN* list 'Top 100 RPGs of all Time'.

ACRONYMS

Term	Meaning
GG	Good Game
glhf	good luck, have fun
ADC	Attack, Damage, Carry
AFK	Away From Keyboard
RPG	Role Playing Game
AAA	High Budget Game
BM	Bad Manners
CTF	Capture The Flag
DLC	Downloadable Content
DPM	Damage Per Minute
DRM	Digital Rights Management
XP	Experience Point
FPS	First Person Shooter
FOV	Field Of View
FPC	Full Perfect Combo
FTP	Free To Play
HoT	Heal Over Time
MMO	Massive Multiplayer Online Game
MOBA	Multiplayer Online Battle Arena
MP	Multiplayer/Magic Points
MUD	Multi-User Domain
NPC	Non-Playable Character
PvE	Player vs Environment
PvP	Player vs Player
RTS	Real Time Strategy

AMPERSANDS

Avoid using ampersands (&) in general text, headings, or subheadings - use 'and' instead.

Headline examples:

CORRECT: Fortnite 'The Device' Event: Details, Leaks, And Theories

INCORRECT: Fortnite 'The Device' Event: Details, Leaks, & Theories

General text examples:

CORRECT: The extra time has allowed dataminers and leakers to peruse the game files.

INCORRECT: The extra time has allowed dataminers & leakers to peruse the game files.

An ampersand may be used in a headline when space is tight, or when it’s part of a company name or game/book title.

APOSTROPHES

Apostrophes are the most commonly misused piece of punctuation.

Do not use them if you're not 100% sure that they're correct - check with the Head of Editorial or your editor.

When it comes to making something plural - never use an apostrophe.

CORRECT: Which RPGs are the best of the best?

INCORRECT: Which RPG's are the best of the best?

APOSTROPHES

In general, only use an apostrophe when you need to form the possessive of the word; not the plural. The exception to this is the plural of it, which is “its.”

Ex. The new president’s office had its own entrance.

Ex. A hard day’s work.

Ex. Freddy’s game was damaged by the rain.

If the word ends in s, just add an apostrophe to form the possessive.

Ex. Several FaZe Clan members' bags were stolen.

Ex. Everyone stared at Charles’ new car, a Jaguar E-type.

ARTICLES, CONJUNCTIONS, AND PREPOSITIONS

Articles

An article is a small word that is associated with a noun. There are three articles: the, a, an.

Conjunctions

Conjunctions are words used to connect words, phrases, or clauses. The most common ones are: and, but, or.

Prepositions

A preposition is a word that tells you where or when something is in relation to something else.

The most common ones are: above, across, against, along, among, around, at, before, behind, below, beneath, beside, between, by, down, from, in, into, near, of, off, on, to, toward, under, upon, with, within.

CAPITALISATION

Game titles

Titles of games should always be in italics (everything but articles, conjunctions, and prepositions capitalised).

Ex. There is a *Counter Strike: Global Offensive* tournament being held this week.

Book titles

Titles of books (and eBooks) are always in italics (everything but articles, conjunctions, and prepositions capitalised). However, there are exceptions.

Note the following example:

Ex. Today I finished *This is Esports (And How to Spell it)* by Paul "RedEye" Chaloner.

Normally 'and' would not be capitalised. However, as it is 'starting a new sentence inside the parentheses, in this exceptional case, it is.

CAPITALISATION

Job titles

Job titles are capitalised only when referencing a specific person, otherwise they're lowercase.

Ex. The new President of the International Esports Federation is Colin Webster.

Ex. The role of the president is to lead the International Esports Federation.

After a colon

Don't capitalise the word after a colon, unless it's a proper noun.

Ex. I'm about to list several things: one, two, and three.

Ex. There are three *BioShock* games: *BioShock 1, BioShock 2*, and *BioShock Infinite.*

LISTS

Don’t use periods after list items in bullet point form, even if they form complete sentences. Do not end list items with commas either.

Similarly, don’t use semicolons or “and” after list items.

Correct

- 100 Thieves
- Alliance
- Astralis
- Cloud9
- Complexity
- Counter Logic Gaming
- Dignitas
- Evil Geniuses
- FaZe Clan

Incorrect

- 100 Thieves;
- Alliance;
- Astralis,
- Cloud9,
- Complexity;
- Counter Logic Gaming,
- Dignitas and
- Evil Geniuses, and
- FaZe Clan.

NUMBERS

Write out numbers up to **and including** ten, except in percents and hard data.

The main exception to this is the name of games, chapters, and seasons.

Ex. Fortnite Chapter 2 - Season 3.

Another exception to this rule is if you have a list of numbers that includes numbers under and above ten: in this case, just make the list consistent (see the second example).

CORRECT: Of the 20 gamers invited, only three decided to go to the party.

INCORRECT: Of the twenty gamers invited, only 3 decided to go to the party.

CORRECT: She has four brothers aged 7, 9, 12, and 15.

INCORRECT: She has four brothers aged seven, nine, 12, and 15.

NUMBERS

Write out numbers at the start of a sentence.

CORRECT: Twenty-two of the commentators agreed.

INCORRECT: 22 of the commentators agreed.

Ordinal numbers (adjectives describing the numerical position of something) should always be written out.

Ex. First, third, tenth.

Use numeric form for percents, but write out at the start of a sentence. Don't include a space between the number and the percent sign.

Ex. The survey results showed that 70% of gamers prefer Xbox to PlayStation.

Ex. Sixty percent of gamers own a second console.

DATE AND TIME

If you are writing out a full date, it should be formatted as follows:

Monday, September 1, 2020

Without the day:

September 1, 2020

Without the year:

September 1

Time:

9am/9pm/9-10am

Include (BST) or (GMT) at the end, as we are a British publication, however please add other time zones after this e.g. (PT) (ET) etc for our international readers.

Ex. The tournament will start at 8pm (BST) / 3pm (ET).

COMMAS AND ELLIPSES

Commas

Use the serial (Oxford) comma before the “and” or “or” in lists. This is a comma placed immediately after the penultimate term (i.e. before the coordinating conjunction [usually and or or]) in a series of three or more terms.

Ex. My hobbies include: gaming, esports, and drinking.

Ellipses

Use non-spaced ellipses, like this: ... (not this: . . .)

Do not use ellipses in a headline.

There should always be a space after an ellipses.

CORRECT: We're not sure what the next update will bring... but we're excited.

INCORRECT: We're not sure what the next update will bring...but we're excited.

HYPHENS

Hyphens

Use hyphens in numeric ranges, but try to use “to” (instead of a hyphen) when including a numeric range in a sentence.

Ex. Numbers 11 to 25 are from the second experiment.

Ex. 9-10am

DASHES

Use a dash with spaces for setting off text or emphasising a point in a sentence.

Ex. Some of the pain points – peer-pressure, lack of sleep, and time differences - are so pressing that they're putting gamers off esports tournaments.

Also, use dashes between a descriptive word and a noun where applicable.

Ex. The brown-haired woman.

Dashes are used to indicate added emphasis, a pause, or a change of thought.

DASHES

Dashes are the “wait for it” of punctuation, creating a pause that is conversational in tone, while still drawing your eye to the next sentence or phrase fluidly.

Dashes can have the same effect as a colon, but with more of an artistic spin, and less of an abrupt stop. (They are also used when attributing a quote).

Ex. "I've been looking for a girl like you - not you, but a girl like you." - Groucho Marx

SEMICOLONS

The semicolon is the second most incorrectly used piece of punctuation after the apostrophe. However, unlike the apostrophe, you don't HAVE to use it day-to-day.

Many people use them to make their writing look more intellectual. Unfortunately, unless you use them correctly, it makes you look the opposite.

Semicolons can be used to link two related independent clauses (complete sentences), or to list items separated by a comma.

Ex. My aunt came over to visit today; she brought her yappy little dog.

Ex. We went to so many awesome places on our trip: London, England; Madrid, Spain; Berlin, Germany; and Miami, Florida.

SEMICOLONS

The semicolon can also be used more creatively, as long as it is conjoining two independent clauses (complete sentences), and does not include a conjunction (with, and, but, because, for, etc.):

CORRECT: Someday I'll have to teach you how to use a crossbow; it's a solid piece of weaponry.

INCORRECT: Someday I'll have to teach you how to use a crossbow; because it's a solid piece of weaponry.

If you don't know, DON'T use them.

COMMON MISTAKES

Between vs. among

Use 'between' with two people or things and 'among' with three or more people or things.

Effect vs. affect

To affect means to produce a change or influence something.

Ex. How will the new Twitch monetisation requirements affect the gaming community?

An effect is a change that has occurred.

Ex. The effect of the new requirements will be negligible.

Affect is a verb 99% of the time; effect is a noun 99% of the time.

COMMON MISTAKES

Insure, ensure, and assure

To insure means to protect against financial loss.

Ex. You are insured against theft.

To ensure means to make certain or to confirm.

Ex. Track your wins to ensure your success.

To assure means to promise. (We assure a person.)

Ex. I can assure you that your valuables are safely locked away.

COMMON MISTAKES

Which vs. that

Which, when used correctly, is part of a nonrestrictive clause, which is preceded or set off by commas. This clause is not essential to the meaning of the sentence, and can be taken out without changing the meaning.

Ex. The tournament, which was gruelling, took place two weeks ago.

That is part of a restrictive clause, which is not set off by commas. This clause is essential to sentence meaning and can't be removed.

Ex. The tournaments that take place in Manchester are especially intense.

Rule of thumb: if the 'which' in the sentence sounds funny with a comma in front of it or around the entire phrase, the sentence probably needs to be using 'that'.

COMMON MISTAKES

Have and Has

A company is always referred to as an individual. So it is GGRecon has, not GGRecon have.

A company is a collective entity. When referring to a company by name, it is the overall entity that is being referenced. It is treated as a single thing.

This applies to game developers, companies, everything that is multiple people.

However, the exception to the rule is esports teams. You would still say FaZe Clan have - even though it is technically wrong - as they are a team and it implies togetherness.

COMMON MISTAKES

Sneak peek - never 'sneak peak'.

CORRECT: We were given a sneak peek of the upcoming game *Cyberpunk 2077*.

INCORRECT: We were given a sneak peak of the upcoming game *Cyberpunk 2077.*

It isn't Esports or eSports - it's esports. If you're starting a sentence with it, it is captialised.

CORRECT: In the world of esports, anything is possible.

INCORRECT: In the world of eSports, anything is possible.

Our company is formatted as GGRecon - not GG Recon or GGrecon.

CORRECT: Here at GGRecon, we love esports.

INCORRECT: Here at GGrecon, we love Esports.

COMMON MISTAKES

OK/okay

Make sure you write it out as 'okay'.

CORRECT: I thought that the tournament was okay - not amazing, not awful.

INCORRECT: I thought that the tournament was OK - not amazing, not awful.

Ensure that all your writing is done in British English - not American. Change your default English in Word or Google Docs to UK rather than US.

POPULAR TEAMS AND PLAYERS

Players

CS:GO
s1mple
dev1ce
Stewie2K
dupreeh
LoL
Faker
Licorice
Rekkles
Wunder
DOTA
iNSaNiA
SumaiL
N0tail
VALORANT
mixwell
brax
TenZ
jasonR
Rocket League
AxB
fruity
Fairy Peak!
Overwatch
super
Viol2t
Fearless

Teams

100 Thieves
Alliance
Astralis
Cloud9
Complexity
Counter Logic Gaming
Dignitas
Evil Geniuses
FaZe Clan
G2 Esports
Immortals
Invictus Gaming
MAD Lions
mousesports
Natus Vincere (NaVi)
Ninjas In Pyjamas
OG
Origen
SK Gaming
SK Telecom T1
Team Envy
Team Liquid
Team Secret
Team SoloMid
Team Vitality
Virtus.pro